

WARHAMMER
40,000

ROLEPLAY

WRATH & GLORY™

RAIN_{OF}MERCY



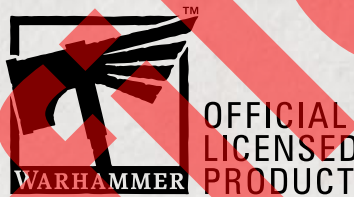
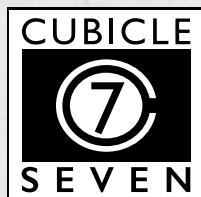
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HEROES NEEDED!

Welcome to this brief introduction to **Warhammer 40,000 Roleplay: Wrath & Glory**. What you hold in your hands (or perhaps read on some advanced dataslate) is a one-shot tabletop roleplaying game adventure set in the grim darkness of the far future. This thrilling adventure explains the basic mechanics of **Wrath & Glory**. Whether you are a veteran explorer of the 41st Millennium, or a prospective new one, the galaxy has recently changed forever — now, more than ever before, heroes are desperately needed!

THE IMPERIUM

In the distant future, the Milky Way Galaxy is dominated by the Imperium, a massive interstellar Human empire directed from Holy Terra — the planet once known as Earth. The Imperium is expansionist and feudal, ruled for more than ten millennia by the Emperor, a man now worshipped as a god.

Since its foundation the Imperium has been beset by enemies on all sides. By the Emperor's ancient decree, Humanity is destined to rule the galaxy, and has fought and extinguished many alien species. Yet the most persistent and terrifying foes of the Imperium are the foul forces of Chaos, nightmarish creatures that corrupt mortal minds, all hailing from the ungodly realm known as the Warp. The Warp is a parallel universe of raw psychic energy, where daemons are

born and Dark Gods dwell, both desiring only the downfall of mortal souls.

The Imperium can only exist on its galaxy-spanning scale by making use of the Warp. Humans born with a rare mutation that allows them to channel the power of the Warp are known as Psykers, individuals feared and revered for their ability to manipulate reality. Astropaths are one type of Psyker, trained to siphon the Warp's power to telepathically communicate over the vast reaches of space. The titanic voidships that carry the Imperium's troops and supplies enter the Warp itself, using arcane technology to travel faster than light. Dabbling with the Warp's unholy powers is risky beyond measure, as demons can sense a channelling Psyker and attempt to possess them at any opportunity, one of few methods they can use to enter reality and pursue their dark desires.

The Emperor Himself is the most powerful Psyker that has ever lived. Interred on His Golden Throne, ruling despite his death-in-life status, part of His magnanimous will still directs the light of the Astronomican: a psychic beacon used by voidships to navigate the turbulent tides of the Warp.

As an expansionist empire, the Imperium boasts the greatest fighting forces in the galaxy. The Astra Militarum, billions strong, travel the galaxy as the Imperial Guard, fighting on alien worlds and dying in droves in the Emperor's name. Elite armies of female warrior-zealots, the Adepta Sororitas, fight holy wars

against profane aliens and those that would refuse His will. Greatest of all are the Emperor's Angels of Death, His Adeptus Astartes, the Space Marines. Once mortal men, each has undergone dramatic gene-enhancement surgery to make them demi-gods of war; larger, faster, stronger, greater in mind and body than any mortal could aspire to be. The Emperor Himself is said to have invented the complex biological process of making a man into a Space Marine — He created warriors capable of accomplishing his will, clad in technologically advanced armour, striding across the galaxy to conquer in His name.

Though much of the Imperium's history has been lost through endless war, stagnation and ignorance, the Emperor's status as a God is beyond question. He is the undying saviour of Humanity, a bulwark against evil, and all lives are owed to him. To deviate from the teachings of the Ecclesiarchy, state church of the Imperium, is a heresy punishable by death. Untold trillions of peasants labour on a million worlds, toiling in horrendous conditions and dying in the name of their God, proud to have lived in service to the Emperor's endless war machine.

THE GREAT RIFT

Though the Imperium stretches wide and its Human armies are mighty, they are far from incorruptible. Far too many unfortunate mortals have fallen from the Emperor's light, lured by promises of power and tempted to serve the daemonic powers of Chaos.

Many say these corrupted blasphemers orchestrated the greatest disaster to befall the Imperium in ten millennia: the emergence of Cicatrix Maledictum, the Warp Storm that tore the galaxy in two.

Though daemonkind usually cannot enter reality unless summoned from the Warp by misguided blasphemers, there are some places where reality and the Warp overlap. These places are known as Warp Rifts, the largest of which form volatile light years-wide Warp Storms that wreak havoc on interstellar travel. Daemonkind walk freely into reality from these Rifts, unsummoned by twisted minds, able to pillage and ruin as they see fit.

The Great Rift is the largest Warp Storm that has ever existed, ripping through all known space, and cutting off half of the Imperium from the Astronomican, light of the Emperor on Holy Terra. Without His guiding light, Warp travel is all but impossible. Ships and psychic messages cannot penetrate the roiling nightmare of the Great Rift. Those on the far side of the Great Rift are isolated and alone — mere Humans standing against powerful daemons and technologically advanced aliens, unsupported by the collective might of the Imperium.

The Humans living beyond the Rift are scared and powerless, some turning in desperation to heresy, others falling prey to the horrors of the grim galaxy. Many still pray for the Emperor to save them, but no few have embraced the heretical belief that the Emperor is dead and they are all damned.

INTRODUCTION

PLANETFALL

INFILTRATE THE
WATER BRINGERS

TORRENTS

RENDER
JUDGEMENT

THE
CHARACTERS



A SYSTEM FORSAKEN

The Gilead System is on the edge of the Imperium Nihilus, surrounded by Warp Storms, held within the tendrils of the Great Rift itself. Founded by a crusade launched by the canonised Lord General Julyanna Gilead, the system proved a proud model of Imperial order for nearly 7,000 years.

Famed for its devout citizens, the system regularly paid its tithes without incident and was upheld as a bastion of faith by the Ecclesiarchy. In addition to the formidable might of its native Imperial Guard Regiments, its citizens rested secure under the watchful eyes of the Absolvers Chapter of the Adeptus Astartes, who had sworn a solemn vow that their vigilance over the system would never fail...

Many such oaths have been broken across the Dark Imperium, but the Absolvers have not faltered. Not yet.

When the Great Rift tore across the galaxy, Gilead was plunged into isolation, cut off from any communications from beyond the system. In the skies over Gilead's worlds the Great Rift's multi-coloured energies burn continuously, darkening the stars and staining their sun.

For three war-torn years, Gilead slipped into darkness and despair. All supply lines became strained, munitions and fuel heavily depleted, with all-too-finite reserves spent on suppressing rebellions, and repelling constant raids from aliens and the forces of Chaos. The majority of the great voidcraft of Gilead fell, one by one, rendered inoperable or utterly destroyed.

Gilead awaited the end.

THE CURSE OF HOPE

Rogue Traders are powerful individuals, given a rare authority to act as militant explorers and interstellar merchants for the Imperium. With their heavily armed ships and crews, these traders push into the unknown, seeking fortune and glory.

Three years after the opening of the Great Rift, Rogue Trader Jakel Varonius, current patriarch of the Varonius dynasty, arrived in the Gilead System with a flotilla of ships at his side. Varonius's fleet found something of incalculable value: a stable route through the Great Rift. The passage was exceedingly perilous, one that Varonius's fleet only managed due to the heroic efforts of an elder Navigator and no small amount of luck. Rumours about this was a one-way trip through the hellish Warp Storm.

Varonius's Flotilla brought supplies, material of every kind, and astounding news: not only did the Imperium survive beyond the Great Rift, but the Primarch Roboute Guilliman, a son of the Emperor, returned after being presumed dead for millenia. Guilliman is now the Imperium's Lord Commander, and his miraculous resurrection heralded the beginning of the Indomitus Crusade. A desperate campaign of epic scale of which Varonius's forces were but a small part, the Crusade is being fought across the galaxy to reclaim the lost worlds of Imperium Nihilus.

To the utter astonishment of the small force of Absolver Astartes still fighting for Gilead, Varonius presented them reinforcements in the form of several squads of Primaris Marines — a new type of advanced Astartes that the Primarch had unleashed to restore

